ISSUE #1 APRIL 2025

HOLLY ROAD & E. PARK PARADE NEWSLETTER

HELLO NEIGHBOURS!

We're lucky to live in a unique corner of Northampton, with our beautiful Victorian homes and a shared service road that connects us all. But like any community, we face challenges—fly-tipping, graffiti, and security concerns are becoming all too common. Instead of standing by, we've decided to take action!

A long-term goal is to install automated gates at both ends of the service road, making it safer and more secure. But that's a big step, and we need everyone's input and support to make it happen. In the meantime, we're rolling up our sleeves and tackling the issues head-on with smaller projects—tidy-up days, security improvements, better lighting, and sharing information to help us all stay safe.

Our **next community meeting will take place on the 30th of April, 7pm at the Picturedrome.** Join us to shape up this neighbourhood together!

BRINGING OUR COMMUNITY TOGETHER: PARTY TIME!

And it's not all work! We want to build a stronger, friendlier community where we actually know our neighbours. That's why we're kicking off with our first street party!

Save the date: 12th of July

Expect BBQs, live music (we know some of you are talented!), and a chance to meet, mingle, and enjoy our neighbourhood together. Just bring yourself, some food to throw on the grill, and whatever you fancy drinking.

Got ideas? Want to help? We'd love to hear from you! Let's make our community one to be proud of.

Get involved—this is our home, let's look after it!

LITTER PICKING

Join us at 10am on the **1st Saturday every month** to get involved and contribute to litter picking the service road and our roads to make where we live a nicer place.
Bring your own bin bags and litter picking grabber if you have one!

ACTION FOR HAPPINESS

The Action for Happiness Northamptonshire Hub is a local movement helping people live well and feel more connected. Whether you're curious about mindfulness, looking for support, or want to bring more joy into your workplace or neighbourhood, there's a place for you here.

👉 Start here: https://linktr.ee/a4hnorthants

🌍 Main Linktree: https://linktr.ee/a4hnorthants

💛 10 Days of Happiness: https://tr.ee/10DaysofHappiness

🗓️ Year of Happier Living (Calendar): https://tr.ee/Calendars

🏃 Active April (Monthly Video): https://tr.ee/ActiveApril (for the months top tips)

A WORD FROM RICHARD CLINTON CEO AT DELAPRE ABBEY PRESERVATION TRUST

'There's a great chance for people to get involved and help shape the future of The Pavilion. We will be asking for feedback on three main areas: first, how The Pavilion can be used as a community space to support culture, creativity, and wellbeing; second, how it can help more people take part in sport and physical activity, and improve access to the Racecourse and sports facilities; and third, how we can restore this historic building in a way that brings back local pride, connects with nature, and is kind to the environment. We expect the consultation sessions to take place in April and May. You'll also be able to share your thoughts online and details of the website and dates will be shared soon.'

USEFUL LINKS

- Friends of Northampton Racecourse
- Holly Road/ East Park Parade Facebook
- Neighbourhood Watch Group

Join our WhatsApp group! →

Holly/EPP Service Road
WhatsApp group

BOOK CLUB

Are you on the lookout for something to read? This is your luck!
Join your friendly neighbours in a new book club, and let's meet to discuss our latest reads!

Contact Marion: +44 7493 900948
and ask to be added on the Holly Road & EPP Book Club's WhatsApp group.

WEED CONTROL AND THE ENVIRONMENT

Many of us love our service road for its unique character, but we also want to keep it tidy and safe. However, the large-scale use of chemical weed killers can have unintended consequences for our local wildlife. Bees, butterflies, and birds rely on the plants and insects in our area, and harsh herbicides can harm them as well as pollute our soil and waterways.

The good news? There are effective, eco-friendly alternatives! Natural solutions like vinegar-based weed sprays, boiling water, or simply pulling weeds by hand can work well in smaller areas. For larger spaces, products containing pelargonic acid (also known as nonanoic acid) offer a more sustainable choice. This naturally occurring fatty acid breaks down plant cells without lingering in the environment. Brands like Neudorff Fast Acting Weedkiller and Roundup NL Weed Control (NL = non-glyphosate) use pelargonic acid and are widely available at garden centers, B&Q, and online retailers.

Other chemical-free methods like mulching and flame weeding (using a flame torch to wilt weeds) are also great options. By choosing greener weed control methods, we can keep our service road looking neat while protecting the environment we all share.
If you'd like to explore alternative solutions together, let's chat!

NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

Engage with the local community and get alerted to events or activity in the area by signing up. Chat to local police as well as other members on the scheme.

- **Scheme name and number:** Holly Road/East Park Parade service road (NoC022)
- **Jackie is Main Co-ordinator, Abbie is Deputy**
- Sign up and we can give you a free leaflet and a sticker for your window
- **Neighbourhood watch in area means fewer burglaries** statistically and can sometimes get discount on home insurance if you are a member
- Local Neighbourhood Watch schemes work in a variety of ways that reflect the needs of the local community. This includes: sharing crime prevention advice and information; running awareness campaigns; holding social events and awards for local people and businesses; leading community projects, such as litter picks, a community café, flood defence response and community messaging with the police.

EXPERIENCE THE JOY OF GENTLE YOGA WITH IVE YOGA
JOIN US FOR GENTLE YOGA IN THE PARK
STARTING JUNE 7TH!

Discover the serenity of gentle yoga in the beautiful outdoors! Ive Yoga is offering peaceful and inclusive yoga classes at Racecourse Park, perfect for all levels. Whether you're a beginner or looking to deepen your practice, our gentle sessions focus on mindful movement, breath awareness, and relaxation.
Ive Yoga is a qualified instructor with four years of teaching experience. Passionate about making yoga accessible to all, Ive Yoga creates a supportive and nurturing environment for everyone to enjoy the benefits of gentle yoga.
The first class will be on June 7th at 10 AM at Racecourse Park. This gentle yoga practice is designed for everyone, providing a soothing experience that enhances flexibility, balance, and overall well-being in a welcoming environment.

Bookings are available via phone at 07355904020 or email at iveyogateacher@gmail.com.
Follow Ive Yoga on Facebook : https://www.facebook.com/iveyoga

RESPONSIBLE PARKING: A COMMUNITY EFFORT

Parking in our neighbourhood can be challenging, and inconsiderate parking can cause frustration and safety risks. As a community, we can improve the situation by parking responsibly and considering the needs of our neighbours.
Key issues include diagonal parking that sticks out into the road, poor parking in the service road, taking up more space than necessary, pavement parking that blocks pedestrians and parking too close to junctions.
Things you can do to help involve parking straight and close to the curb, leaving enough space for other vehicles, ensuring you do not block access to garages and gates in the service road, ensuring at least 1.5 metres of space for pedestrians, leaving at least 10 meters from junctions, and considering alternative parking options like the Racecourse Car Park (which is free currently).
Responsible parking is about being a good neighbour and keeping our streets accessible and welcoming for everyone

PUBLICATION

If you too want to create a social group, have an announcement to make, friendly advice to give, or want to advertise in this newsletter (£5/advert) send us your article at:

NN1serviceroad@outlook.co.uk